

04/29/2026

To whom it may concern,

It is my pleasure to recommend Zackery Duhala for a teaching position as he completes his teaching credential program. This will be my third summer working with Zack within our YMCA day camps, and I have had the privilege of witnessing his remarkable development as an educator and leader. From the moment he joined our staff, Zack quickly showcased his dedication to supporting the youth of our community. His adaptability, determination, and compassion became extremely apparent as he worked with a diverse population of multi-cultural students in an unfamiliar socio-economic area. He was an integral piece in helping to facilitate an inclusive social environment in our camp where each child felt safe and welcomed.

Last summer, Zack stepped into a unit leader role and truly excelled. He quickly displayed exceptional leadership qualities and set himself apart with his ability to connect with all age groups from K-6th grade, manage larger groups of children, and make a significant impact on his peers by training other staff members on policies and instructional strategies that would make them more successful. Within our camp, Zack was often tasked with creating art projects, leading discussions, and facilitating outdoor activities while adapting them to fit the developmental needs of various age groups. He also led specialty activities such as sports and animal encounters for all ages. On each occasion, Zack eagerly accepted the opportunity to challenge himself and used each experience as a moment for professional growth and learning.

Zack has a natural ability to connect with others and create meaningful relationships with our YMCA staff, branch leaders, and the families he works with including students and parents alike. I truly believe that our YMCA setting has been the perfect environment for Zack to develop professionally toward his teaching career. This will be his last summer with us, and we will miss his presence in our camp space.

Zack has not only shown that he can lead a group of students, but that he can truly make an impact on their development through his dedication, compassion, and caring nature. Zack is hardworking, flexible, reliable, and has always shown a willingness to learn and improve. I have full confidence in his abilities to succeed as a classroom teacher and to make a positive difference in the lives of his students. Any school would be fortunate to have him join their faculty.

If you have any questions, please feel free to reach out at 619-675-5020.

Best,



Adrian Araiza
YMCA Program Director